Chase Burns

CIN · RHP · Starter · Age 23 · 2,569 pitches · 29 G

Pitcher evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 695505

IP	ERA	FIP	XFIP	XERA	K%	BB%	K-BB%	CSW%	WHIFF%	CHASE%	FB VELO
154.1	2.86	3.24	3.44	3.24	29.4%	8.9%	20.5%	28.6%	29.5%	34.3%	97.6

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Best pitch: slider (80 Stuff / 75 Results):** 49.7% whiff, .196 xwOBA, 39% usage; 12th-most velo of 196 RHP sliders (90.2 mph); already his 2-strike weapon (50% of 2K pitches).
2. **Elite overall stuff (75):** usage-weighted Stuff +1.05 RV/100, primary FB 97.6 mph (90th pct).
3. **Predictable in 3-1 vs LHH:** 89% four-seams (n=36) — the count a hitter can sit on one pitch.
4. **Platoon gap:** .332 wOBA allowed to LHH vs .238 to the other side (94 pts; 395 / 226 PA vs L / R).
5. **Strong run prevention by xERA:** 2.86 ERA, 3.24 xERA (84th pct), 3.24 FIP, 20.5% K-BB.

20–80 GRADES

vs 424 pitchers ≥600 pitches

Stuff	75	+1.05 RV/100
Command	40	BB 8.9%
Bat-missing	65	Whiff 29%
Contact mgmt	50	xwOBAcon .344
Durability	50	IP/GS 5.3

ARSENAL Arsenal — slider is the best pitch by shape (80 Stuff, elite)

Velo mph · spin rpm · IVB/HB inches, catcher view (HB + = toward 1B) · Ext ft · Whiff per swing · Chase = swing % outside zone · xwOBA per PA ended · RV/100 = count-neutral run value per 100 pitches, + = good for pitcher · cells tinted by percentile within pitch type & hand · grey rows: n < 100

		USAGE			USAGE BY COUNT				SHAPE					RESULTS					GRADES (20–80)		
PITCH	N	ALL	VL	VR	0-0	AHD	BHD	2K	VELO	SPIN	IVB	HB	EXT	WHIFF	CHASE	CSW	XWOBA	RV/100	STUFF	RES	CMD
Four-seam FF	1422	**55%**	57%	52%	63%	48%	66%	47%	97.6	2633	18.5	-3.4	6.3	15%	29%	25%	.335	+0.3	70	45	50
Slider SL	1000	**39%**	35%	46%	32%	45%	30%	50%	90.2	2774	0.4	3.2	6.3	50%	41%	36%	.196	+1.8	80	75	35
Changeup CH	134	**5%**	8%	0%	4%	6%	5%	2%	90.2	1831	10.3	-14.8	6.2	33%	26%	19%	.433	-6.8	65	40	35

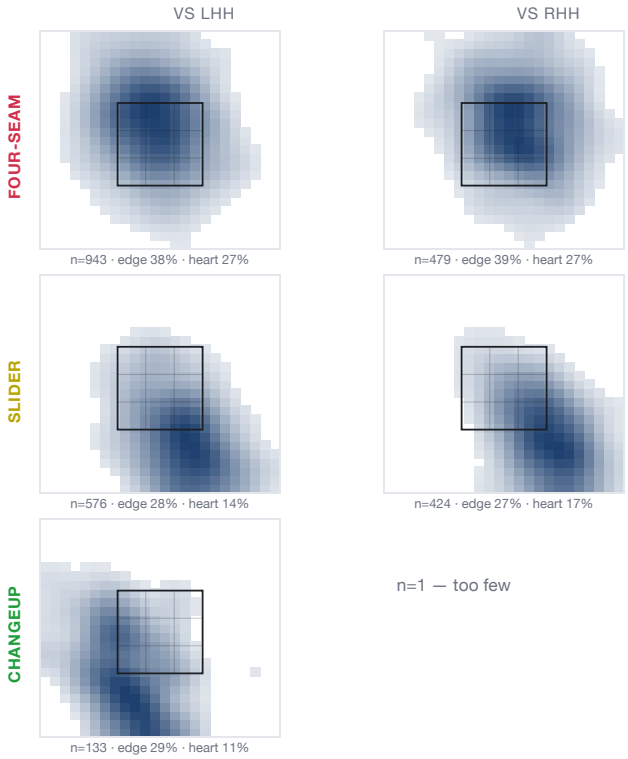
SHAPE Movement — four-seam carries 2.9 more IVB than the average RHP four-seam

Dots = individual pitches (≤110 per type); large markers = his averages; dashed ellipses = league 1-SD shape for the same pitch type from RHPs. Inches, catcher view.



LOCATION Location — 57% of his four-seams finish in the upper third or above

Smoothed density of pitch locations (catcher view; box = average rule-book zone, thirds marked). Darker = more frequent (frequency, not quality) · edge = within ±3 in of the zone border.



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COUNTS Count strategy — most predictable in 3-1 vs LHH (89% four-seam)

Throws most = his most-used pitch in each count (tint: red = mixed, blue = ≥70% one pitch, i.e. predictable). Model pick = lowest expected xwOBA from the situational model vs a league-average hitter (◆ = differs). Mix gap = his actual mix's model xwOBA minus the model pick's, in points (.001); blue = larger opportunity.

VS LHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 65% n=399	FF 62% n=157	FF 72% n=58	FF 95% n=20	FF 52% n=208	FF 44% n=167	FF 64% n=86	FF 89% n=36	FF 49% n=113	FF 49% n=161	SL 50% n=151	FF 56% n=96
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FF	FF	FF	SL ◆	FF	FF	FF ◆	SL ◆
Mix gap (pts)	3	3	6	19	11	8	3	31	11	9	4	5

VS RHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 62% n=224	FF 58% n=92	FF 74% n=31	FF 86% n=7	SL 51% n=111	FF 52% n=90	SL 56% n=57	FF 100% n=13	SL 51% n=68	SL 62% n=76	SL 56% n=89	SL 57% n=46
Model pick	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	FF	FF ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	FF ◆	FF ◆	FF ◆
Mix gap (pts)	0	0	3	14	13	7	5	28	13	13	6	1

MOST PREDICTABLE

3-1 vs LHH · **89% FF** n=36
2-0 vs RHH · **74% FF** n=31
2-0 vs LHH · **72% FF** n=58

LARGEST MODEL GAPS

0-1 vs RHH · SL 51% → **FF** .284→.259
0-2 vs RHH · SL 51% → **FF** .285→.260
3-1 vs LHH · FF 89% → **SL** .321→.288

SEQUENCE Sequencing — FF/SL is the best tunnel pair (4.3× separation after the decision point)

Share (%) of next pitch within the same PA, by previous pitch. Tunnel = mean trajectories 23.8 ft from the plate vs at the plate.

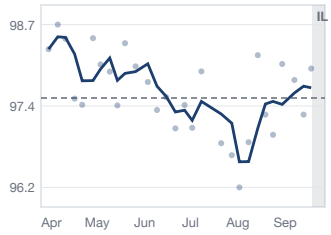
AFTER ↓ / NEXT →	FF	SL	CH
FF n=1079	54	39	6
SL n=731	50	45	5
CH n=112	60	34	6

Best tunnel: **FF/SL** — 4.4 in apart at the decision point, 18.7 in apart at the plate (4.3× late separation; release 3.0 in apart)
Slider after FF: **51% whiff** vs 50% overall (226 swings)
Four-seam after CH: **9% whiff** vs 15% overall (35 swings)

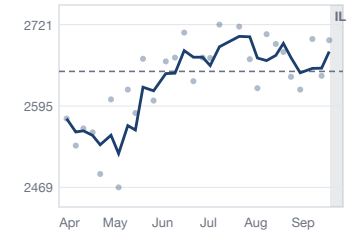
TRENDS Trends — stable through the season

Per game (dots), 3-game rolling mean (line), dashed = baseline before last 5 games; ⚑ shaded = flagged window (≥1 mph, 75 rpm or 0.2 ft). Grey = IL: Sep 19–Sep 28 (Right groin strain).

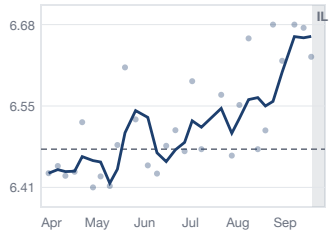
Primary FB velo (mph)



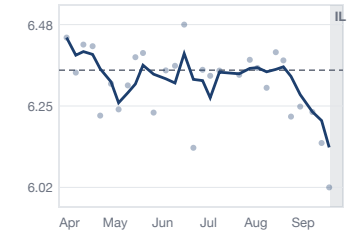
Primary FB spin (rpm)



Release height (ft)



Extension (ft)



SPLITS Splits — LHH do more damage (47-pt xwOBA gap)

Statcast PAs, regular season. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for him). Times through order use the batter's PA count vs this pitcher in the game. Velo hold: primary FB -0.5 mph on pitches 76+ vs 1–25. Grey rows: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	WHIFF	CHASE
vs LHH	395	.332	.297	29.4%	11.4%	14	28%	33%
vs RHH	226	.238	.250	30.5%	4.9%	3	31%	37%
1st time	259	.265	.258	32.8%	9.7%	4	31%	33%
2nd time	240	.298	.280	29.6%	9.6%	8	29%	37%
3rd+ time	122	.368	.325	23.8%	6.6%	5	26%	33%

COMPS Comps — closest arsenal profile: Dylan Cease

Nearest neighbors among qualified pitchers on pitch mix, primary-FB velo/IVB/HB, arm angle, breaking-ball shape and separation, whiff% and zone% (standardized, weighted). Chip = comp's Stuff grade.

Dylan Cease TOR 65 — 69% similar
RHP SP · FB 96.8 mph, 18" IVB · FF 37% / SL 30% / CH 11% / CU 10%

Clayton Beeter WSH 60 — 62% similar
RHP RP · FB 95.7 mph, 18" IVB · SL 50% / FF 49%

Michael Petersen MIA 70 — 61% similar
RHP RP · FB 98.0 mph, 19" IVB · FF 61% / SL 26% / CH 12%

DEVELOP Development notes — usage direction from the arsenal optimizer

Constrained optimizer on the outcome model (each pitch ±15 pts, 3–55% bounds). Expected gains are small and model-dependent: hypotheses for the pitching staff, not prescriptions.

vs LHH: SL 35→50%, FF 57→47%, CH 8→3% (model xwOBA -2 pts, n=1652)
vs RHH: FF 53→45%, SL 47→55% (model xwOBA -1 pts, n=904)

Grades. each scale is a z-score composite converted to a percentile within the qualified pool, then 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80 and shown to the nearest 5. Pitch grades are within the same pitch type and throwing hand (≥100 pitches). Stuff = a gradient-boosted model of expected, count-neutral run value from velo, movement, spin, extension, release, arm angle and separation from the primary fastball (no location or results; held-out pitch-type correlation r=0.37). Results = whiff%, CSW%, xwOBA. Command = edge%, waste%, heart% (pitch) and BB%, edge, zone, first-strike (overall). Durability = IP/start, pitches/game, late-game velo hold (relievers: G, IP). **Models.** count plan = situational pitch-type model (2026, generic league-average hitter, medium leverage, 2nd time through); location/tunneling from Statcast trajectory fits at a 23.8 ft decision point; usage suggestion = constrained arsenal optimizer (±15 pts/pitch). Model gaps are small effects — treat as direction. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; small-sample cells greyed; xwOBA ignores park and defense; IL dates from MLB transactions (retroactive dates honored).